



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

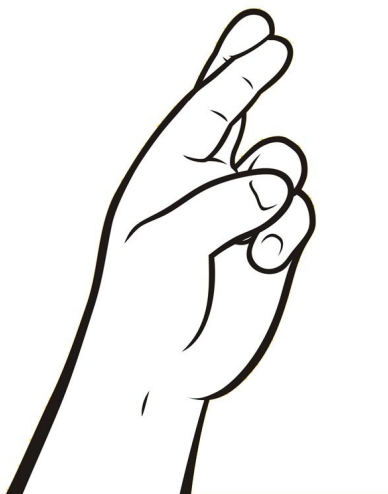
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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Taking things too far ...



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write about manners, customs and superstitions.
- I can write about hypothetical situations.
- I can write a short narrative paragraph.

Ask your partner:

- Are any of your friends or family superstitious?
- Why do you think people believe in superstitions?





Let's Explore!

Can superstitious behaviors be **taken too far***?

* When something is "taken too far," it is at the point where it's no longer funny or interesting.



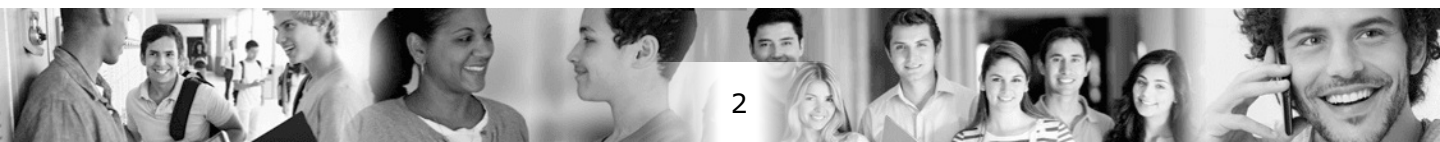
Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Now, it's time to share a tale about a superstitious man from New Jersey. If I was his girlfriend, I wouldn't be holding hands with this guy in the near future!

A 25-year-old man, who was supposed to be taking his girlfriend to pick out engagement rings, caused a five-car pileup during rush hour. Richard Dalton, of New York, told detectives he fainted yesterday morning while holding his breath in the tunnel near the community of Bakersfield.

His car drifted across the centerline and crashed head-on with a transport truck. Both vehicles struck the tunnel walls before veering into other traffic. Paramedics found victims comforting each other in the mayhem. If it had not been for the quick action of other drivers at the scene, the accident could have ended in tragedy. During the investigation, police complained that some bystanders, who were supposed to remain behind the police tape, refused to let crews through, stood too close to the emergency vehicles and attempted to take photos on their cell phones.

Dalton and his passenger girlfriend, suffered non-life-threatening injuries. Dalton was cited for reckless driving. Investigators state that if the health of any of the victim's declined in hospital, additional charges would be added. A police lieutenant said he's not sure why Dalton was holding his breath. However, his girlfriend stated that her superstitious soulmate holds his breath in tunnels. "After the accident, I was crossing my fingers that no one was seriously hurt," she said to police. "We were supposed to be getting married next week." In the end, the couple decided to part ways.





Let's Practice!

Superstitions can cause some awkward* situations.

*"Awkward" situations are embarrassing or inconvenient moments.

Instructions: Match the phrases from Column A with the phrases from Column B to correctly complete each statement.

COLUMN A

1. If you are superstitious,
2. If the man hadn't held his breath in the tunnel,
3. If the drivers hadn't acted quickly,
4. If any of the victims' health declined in the hospital,
5. If the accident hadn't happened,

COLUMN B

- a. authorities would add more charges to the reckless driver.
- b. he would have paid more attention to the road.
- c. you'll be able to experience awkward situations.
- d. there would have been a tragedy.
- e. the man and his girlfriend wouldn't have canceled their wedding.



Let's Practice!

Paula is talking to a friend about a story she read on a blog.

Instructions: Read the dialogue. Complete the gaps with the phrases given.

John: Did you hear the story?

Paula: I wrote about it. What an awkward situation.

John: I know. He _____ attention to the road, but he was holding his breath instead. That's a reckless driver.

Paula: He _____ this silly superstition.

John: That's right. And his girlfriend _____ him not to hold his breath!

Paula: I don't think so. She can't control her boyfriend's behaviors.

John: And they _____ married, but they canceled it.

Paula: If I had been the girl, I would have cancelled it, too. They _____ soulmates, then!

Phrases

- wasn't supposed to do
- was supposed to pay
- weren't supposed to be
- were supposed to get
- was supposed to tell



Extension Activity

Talk about all the things you have to do.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Pretend it is Halloween. You have lots to do and you are very busy.
- Use "supposed to" and "not supposed to" to make a list of 5 sentences about all the things you need to do, but didn't.
- Then use "If I had ..." to talk about all the things you would do if you had more time.
- Compare your lists with a partner.
- Edit each other's sentences.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about manners, customs and superstitions.

☐
☐

I talk about things I was "supposed to" do and things that were "supposed to" happen.

☐
☐

I talk about hypothetical situations.

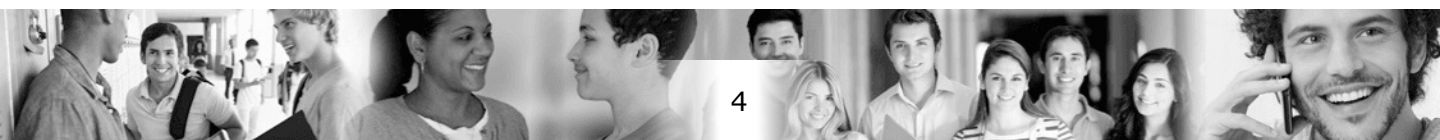
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I edit other people's work.

☐
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Target Words

- to faint** (verb): to lose consciousness temporarily
e.g. Richard Dalton fainted yesterday morning.
- pileup** (noun): a collision of multiple cars
e.g. He caused a five-car pileup during rush hour.
- tunnel** (noun): an underground passage, especially for cars or trains
e.g. He was holding his breath in the tunnel near Bakersfield.
- to drift** (verb): to deviate from a regular course
e.g. His car drifted across the centerline.
- to veer** (verb): to change direction of course
e.g. Both vehicles struck the walls before veering into other traffic.
- mayhem** (noun): random damage
e.g. Victims comforted each other in the mayhem.
- to cite** (verb): to call to a public audience
e.g. Dalton was cited because of the accident he caused.
- reckless** (adjective): careless; irresponsible
e.g. Dalton's reckless driving caused the accident.
- soulmate** (noun): a person, friend or couple, who completely understands another person
e.g. Dalton's girlfriend said her soulmate holds his breath in tunnels.
- crew** (noun): a group of people who work together, in the police, as doctors, etc.
e.g. Bystanders refused to let crews through.





Learning Points

Writing a Narrative Paragraph

Narrative is the term for a story, long or short. It can be written about the past, present, or future. It may be factual or imagined.

A narrative needs characters, a setting and a clear problem to be interesting to an audience.

1. Decide what type of story you are writing (mystery, fantasy, adventure).
2. Decide who is the narrator (the person speaking).
3. Choose the characters and the setting (where and when).
4. Write the problem or conflict.
5. What happens at the end?

You often use these verbs in narratives to describe things that happened in the past.

Past tense

Example: *The young man was terrified of walking under ladders.*

Past Continuous tense

Example: *Jonathan was walking home late at night when he saw a black cat cross his path.*

Past Perfect tense

Example: *He had always avoided going through tunnels.*

Past Perfect Continuous tense

Example: *It had been raining for days.*

Linking words help to structure a narrative and connect ideas. They help to provide a sequence of events.

You can use words like:

During	Soon	Immediately
Once	As soon as	Finally
In the end	At last	Suddenly

Examples:

- *During the investigation, police complained that some bystanders, who were supposed to remain behind the police tape, refused to let crews through.*
- *In the end, the couple decided to part ways.*





Learning Points

Conditional Sentences with *If* Clause

There are two kinds of conditional sentences: real and unreal. The Real Conditional describes real-life situations. The Unreal Conditional describes unreal, imaginary situations.

Zero conditional sentences have two present simple verbs, one in the *if* clause and one in the main clause. You use this conditional when the result will always happen.

You use the form:

If + present simple, ... present simple.

You use the first conditional with *if* clauses to exchange opinions about possible future outcomes.

You use the form:

If + present simple, ... will + base form

You use the second conditional to exchange opinions about unreal or imaginary (hypothetical) situations in the future.

You use the form:

If + past simple, ... would + base form

You use the third conditional to talk about the past. It is used to describe a situation that didn't happen, and to imagine the result of this situation.

If + past perfect, ... would + have + past participle

Examples:

- *If I were his girlfriend, I wouldn't be holding hands with this guy in the near future!*
- *If it had not been for the quick action of other drivers at the scene, the accident could have ended in tragedy.*
- *Investigators stated that if the health of any of the victims declined in hospital, additional charges would be added.*

